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INTERIM REVISION OF
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February 7, 1955

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MOP, DUSTING, COTTON, SLIP-ON (WITH HANDLE)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification T-M-570, dated February 7, 1955.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a slip-on cotton-yarn dusting mop (mophead, handle and frame) primarily intended for use in dusting floors.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Sizes. Mops covered by this specification shall be of one type (see figures 1, 2,* and 3) and shall be furnished in the following sizes (length of frame), as specified:

Size 9-3/4 - 9-3/4 inches
Size 12-1/4 - 12-1/4 inches
Size 15-1/4 - 15-1/4 inches
Size 22-1/4 - 22-1/4 inches

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton.
CCC-T-191 - Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20406.

FSC 7920

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specification and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample approval. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) before production is commenced, a sample of the mop to be supplied shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for examination and approval in accordance with 4.2. Approval of the preproduction sample authorizes commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Yarn for mophead. The yarn used in the mophead shall be not less than 4-ply cotton having not less than 3.5 turns per inch and a breaking strength of not less than 12 pounds. The yarn shall weight not less than 615 yards per pound.

3.2.2 Sewing thread. Sewing thread shall conform to the requirements of V-T-276, type IA1, 4-cord, ticket number 24, for sewing yarn and binding to body of mophead, and 3-cord, ticket number 40, for bartacking tape ties.

3.2.3 Cloth, cotton, duck. The cotton duck used for the mophead shall comply with the minimum requirements of table I when tested as specified in 4.4. The cloth shall have not more than 1 percent residual shrinkage when tested in accordance with 4.4.

3.2.4 Binding. The binding shall be made of twill or drill conforming to the minimum physical requirements of table I when tested as specified in 4.4 and shall be cut on the bias. The cloth shall have not more than 1 percent residual shrinkage when tested in accordance with 4.4.

Table I. Physical requirements.

| Material | Weight oz/sq. yd. (min) | Yarns per inch (min) | | Breaking Strength pounds (min) | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Warp | Filling | Warp | Filling |
| Cotton duck | 12.0 | 76 | 31 | 190 | 150 |
| Twill or drill | 6.8 | 70 | 58 | 140 | 90 |



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3.2.5 Tape for ties. Tape for the ties shall be a tubular braid of unbleached cotton yarns. The tape shall measure not less than 1/4 inch in width.

3.2.6 Handle. The handle shall be of close-grained hardwood, or softwood of Douglas fir or southern yellow pine, and shall be dried to a moisture content of not more than 12 percent. The handle shall be straight and free from warp, decay, knots, checks, shakes, splits, slivers, bark pocket, and larva channels or pockets. The slope of grain shall be not steeper than 1 inch in 15 inches unless the dip-grain does not exceed half the diameter of the handle.

3.2.6.1 Finish. The surface of hardwood and softwood handles shall be sanded smooth and waxed. Douglas fir and southern yellow pine handles shall be coated with not less than two coats of clear lacquer or varnish.

3.2.7 Handle fittings.

3.2.7.1 Sleeve. The sleeve shall be of seamless steel or aluminum tubing having a thickness of 0.035 $\pm$ 0.004 inch. If steel is used, it shall be zinc or cadmium-plated.

3.2.7.2 Bail. The bail shall be of zinc or cadmium-plated spring-steel wire having a thickness of 0.162 $\pm$ 0.004 inch.

3.2.7.3 Base plate. The base plate shall be of zinc or cadmium-plated steel 0.037 $\pm$ 0.004 inch thick.

3.2.7.4 Swivel plate. The swivel plate shall be of zinc or cadmium-plated steel having a thickness of 0.050 $\pm$ 0.004 inch.

3.2.7.5 Rivet. The rivet shall be of steel having a shank approximately 1/4 inch thick and a head approximately 1/2 inch in diameter. It shall be approximately 11/16 inch long.

3.2.7.6 Washers. Washers shall be of steel, and shall be either a flat type or recessed type.

3.2.7.6.1 Flat type. Flat-type washers shall be approximately 1/2 inch in diameter.

3.2.7.6.2 Recessed types. Recessed-type washers shall be approximately 11/16 inch in diameter.

3.2.7.7 Spring. The spring shall be of the compression type and shall be of steel.

3.3 Construction. The mop assembly shall consist of a removable mophead, handle and frame (see figures 1, 2, and 3).

3.3.1 Mophead. The mophead shall be made from two pieces of cotton duck (3.2.3). One piece, forming the bottom, shall have three rows of yarn securely sewn thereon. The other piece, forming the top, shall have an opening for the insertion of the frame. The opening shall be bound with twill or drill (3.2.4). Mophead sizes 16, 19, and 23 shall have two ties, one on each side of the opening, attached by means of bartacking. Size 30 mophead shall have four ties, two on each side. Ties shall be approximately eight inches long. The two pieces, top and bottom, shall be securely bound together around the edges, thus giving the appearance of a slipper. The binding shall be twill or drill as specified in 3.2.4. After binding together, an additional row of yarn shall be sewed around the outer edge. The yarns, after being sewed to the bottom section, shall be not less than 2-1/2 inches long. The sweep (mophead surface) of the finished mopheads shall measure not less than 9-1/2 inches in width, and 16, 19, 23, and 30 inches in length for frame sizes 9-3/4, 12-1/4, 15-1/4, and 22-1/4 respectively. Length and width of the mopheads shall be measured from yarn tip to yarn tip.



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3.3.2 Handle and frame. The handle shall be 53 inches, ± 1/2 inch, long and not less than 7/8 nor more than 15/16 inch thick. One end shall be square, routed, and grooved for attachment of the bail. The other end of the handle shall be rounded. The handle shall be smooth and waxed, or coated with transparent lacquer (see 3.2.6.1). The frame and handle fittings, consisting of a bail, wire frame, swivel plate, face plate, rivet, compression spring, washers, and sleeve, shall be as follows: The bail shall be shaped so that it will penetrate the routing in the handle, recess itself in the grooves, and fit into the holes in the swivel plate, thus holding the frame by means of spring action. The bail shall be flared in opposite directions on the ends. The swivel plate shall be approximately 2-5/8 inches in diameter, have four equally spaced position-holes, and two upturned lips with holes for insertion of the prongs of the bail. The base plate shall be 2-7/8 inches, ± 1/32 inch, wide. The base plate shall have four equally spaced impressions to match the holes in the swivel. The ends of the plate shall be curled around the wire frame which is bent in the form of an ellipse. The wire frame shall measure 9-3/4, 12-1/4, 15-1/4, and 22-1/4 inches from tip to tip. A tolerance of ± 1/4 inch will be permitted. The width, including the base plate, for all sizes shall be 3-3/8 inches, ± 1/32 inch. The sleeve shall be not less than 1-9/16 inches long with an inside dimension of 15/16, ± 1/64 inch. One end of the sleeve shall be flared. The sleeve shall be pierced to prevent slippage.

3.4 Workmanship. The mop assemblies shall be clean and free from defects which affect the appearance or which might impair the serviceability.

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When required, the preproduction sample submitted in accordance with 3.1 shall be inspected for all the provisions of this specification applicable to end product examination and tests.

4.3 Sampling and inspection. Sampling and inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein. For purposes of sampling. an inspection lot for acceptance inspection and tests shall consist of all complete mop assemblies or component parts (when purchased separately) of the same size offered for delivery at one time.

4.3.1 Visual examination. Sample mop assemblies or component parts (if purchased separately) shall be taken at random from the lot and examined in accordance with classification of defects listed in table II. The sample unit shall consist of the item (complete mop, mophead, or handle and frame) as delivered. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 major and 4.0 minor defects per hundred units.

Table II. Classification of defects

| Examine | Defects | Classification | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor |
| Mophead | Not material as specified. | X | |
| | Construction not as specified. | X | |
| | Dimensions not as specified within tolerances. | X | |
| | Number of rows and length of mophead yarn less than specified. | X | |
| | Mophead yarn less than 4 ply. | X | |



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Table II. Classification of defects (cont'd)

| Examine | Defects | Classification | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor |
| Mophead (cont'd) | Specified number of ties omitted. | X | |
| | Rancid or objectionable odor. | | X |
| | Spotted, soiled or stained. | | X |
| | Insect infestation. | | X |
| Handle and frame | Not material specified. | X | |
| | Not smoothly finished. | X | |
| | Wood handle not coated or waxed. | | X |
| | Construction of frame not as specified. | X | |
| | Dimensions not as specified within tolerances. | X | |
| | Metal parts not rust free. | X | |

4.3.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table III. Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

| Examine | Defects |
|---|---|
| Markings (exterior and interior) | Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application. |
| Materials | Any component missing, or damaged. |
| Workmanship | Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping or distortion of container. |

4.4 Tests. The methods of testing as specified in CCC-T-191, wherever applicable, and as listed in table IV shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the determinations made on a unit of product for test purposes as specified in the applicable test method.

Table IV. Test methods

| Characteristic | Requirement Paragraph | Test Method |
|---|---|---|
| Mop Yarn (plied) | | |
| Turns per inch | 3.2.1 | 4054 |
| Breaking strength | 3.2.1 | 4100 |
| Yards per pound | 3.2.1 | 4010 |
| Cloth, cotton duck, and drill or twill | | |
| Weight, oz./sq.yd. | Table I | 5041 |
| Yarns per inch | Table I | 5050 |
| Breaking strength | Table I | 5100 |
| Shrinkage in laundering | Table I | 5550 |



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4.4.1 Testing criteria. Sample unit for testing shall be as specified in subsidiary specifications and as follows:

| Component | Lot size expressed as | Sample unit |
|---|---|---|
| Mop yarn | Yards | 40 yards 1/ 2/ |
| Cloth, cotton, duck | Yards | 3 yards full width |
| Cloth, cotton, drill or twill | Yards | 3 yards full width |
| Thread, cotton | Bobbins, cones, or spools | A sufficient quantity to total a minimum of 360 yds. 3/ |

1/ Not less than 3 sample units from each lot shall be tested.
2/ Unless otherwise specified, five specimens shall be tested from each sample unit.
3/ When thread is purchased on cones, spools, and bobbins, each shall be tested.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Mopheads, handles and frames, or complete mops. Mopheads, handles and frames, or complete mops of like description in sizes as specified (see 6.1) shall be packed in quantities of 12 in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed, waterproofed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Mopheads, handles and frames, or complete mops. Mopheads, handles and frames or complete mops of like description in sizes as specified (see 6.1) shall be packed in quantities of 12 in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The mopheads, handles and frames, or complete mops shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rates, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:



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(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size of mop required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(d) Selection of applicable level of packing required (see 5.1).

6.2 Illustrations. The illustrations shown herein as figures 1, 2, and 3 are for purposes of illustrating the general design and are not intended to preclude any mophead or mop frame which otherwise meets the requirements of this specification.

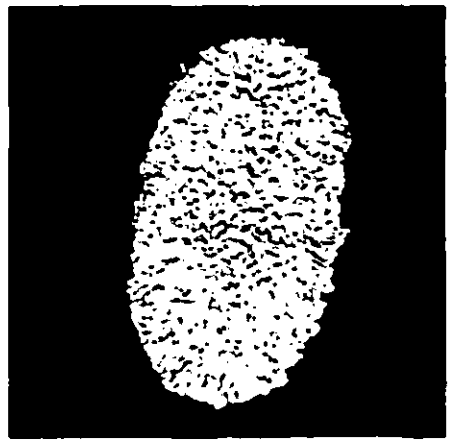


Figure 1

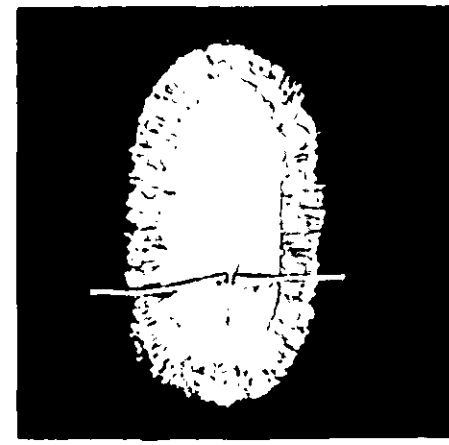


Figure 2

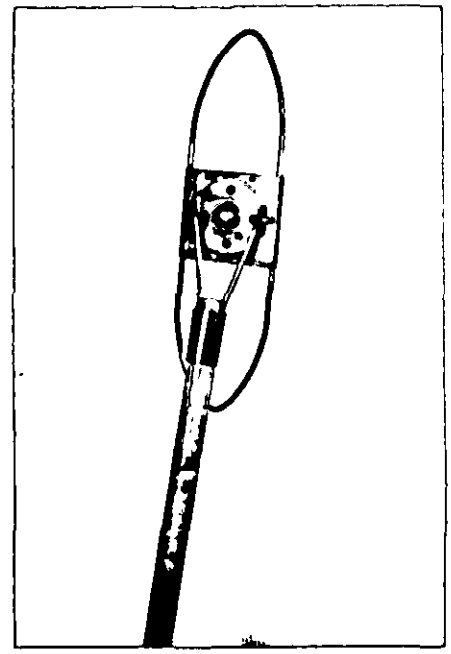


Figure 3



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